**adapt** a · dapt

### Advanced Definition

**transitive verb**

1. to make fit or suitable for a particular need or condition; adjust.

   *They adapted the reading room so they could hold meetings there.*
   *The school water fountains are adapted for children.*

**intransitive verb**

1. to become adjusted.

   *The children of the immigrants adapted quickly to their new surroundings.*

### Spanish cognate

*adaptar*. The Spanish word *adaptar* means adapt.

### These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. One by one, the other races have gone extinct. The hypothesized reasons range from an inability to adapt to climate change to murder at the hands of more advanced humans.
2. No longer tied to the land, the marine reptiles could fully adapt to living in the ocean and compete with sharks and other big fish. “The interesting fact is that just about every animal in the ocean is a predator —from the smallest minnow to the biggest mosasaur—while almost all land animals are herbivores [plant eaters],” says Everhart.
3. Natural selection allows animals that have traits best suited to a particular environment to survive and produce offspring. Animals who are unable to adapt to changes in their environments die off
4. Another interesting variable that lets organism populations adapt to changing environments is mutation in genes. Sometimes, unpredictable changes in genetic code will appear within a new generation, not traceable back to a parental source.
5. Conservative Jews believe in the traditional beliefs and values of Judaism. The difference is that they adapt these beliefs to fit the times. This form of Judaism was developed in the mid 1800s. Conservative Jews follow many of the same rules as Orthodox Jews. However, they are more willing to change the rules if they feel it is needed.
6. Darwin’s theory teaches us that an animal or plant that adapts to its environment and remains alive long enough to procreate will thrive. The dodo bird, which has gone extinct, was not lucky in this respect. A lack of predators for thousands, and maybe even millions, of years meant that the dodos never learned to fly. When humans finally arrived to their home on the island of Mauritius, the dodos had no way of protecting themselves and, in the 17th century, were wiped out.
7. But Emine was determined to adapt to the city’s frenetic energy. On her first evening in Cairo, she took a stroll from her hotel to the banks of the Nile, and watched the boats bobbing lazily on the water. Away
8. Zoe had specialized in behavioral ecology during her studies at university, so when she applied for a job at the zoo, she specified that she was very interested in the ways animals adapt their behavior to changing environmental factors.
9. Many of these species are endemic to tropical rainforests,
   meaning that rainforests are the only place they live on Earth. Some have had to adapt to their surroundings in order to survive. For example, toucans and parrots both have very large, strong beaks. These pc
   trees.
10. Before the breakup of Pangaea, many scientists believe, all of life was situated in one ecosystem, and did not have any reason to adapt to change. Once Pangaea broke up, it was possible for evolution to happen at an increased rate.

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